SpeedUP

English Course

Words for Requests, Offers & Permissions

request (pedido, solicitação)
💬 Can I make a **request**?

2. offer (oferta, oferecer)
💬 She **offered** to help with the bags.

3. permission
➜ Do I have your **permission** to leave early?

7. mind (importar-se)
💬 Do you **mind** if I sit here?

3. permissão, autorização)
➜ Do I have your **permission** to leave early?

4. allow (permitir, deixar)
📱 My boss doesn't **allow** phones at the table.

5. permit (permitir (formal)
🚬 Smoking is not **permitted** in this area.

6. favor (favoritir (formal)
💬 Could you do me a **favor**?

7. mind (importar-se)
➜ Do you **mind** if I sit here?

10. decline (recusar, declinar)
➜ He politely **declined** the offer.

8. polite (polite, cortês)
💬 It's polite to say "please" and "thank you".

9. grant (concesitor, conceder)
📲 She granted **permission** to use the room.

Words for Requests, Offers & Permissions

A **request** is when you ask someone to do something. The more formal or indirect the structure, the more polite it sounds.

Structure Overview:

Structure	Formality	Example
Can you...?	informal	*Can you pass the salt?*
Could you...?	neutral / polite	*Could you send me the file?*
Would you...?	polite	*Would you help me with this?*
Would you mind...?	polite / careful	*Would you mind waiting a moment?*
Could you possibly...?	very polite	*Could you possibly reschedule the meeting?*
I was wondering if you could...	formal	*I was wondering if you could review my report.*

Responding to Requests: Accepting & Declining

✅ Accepting a request:

❌ Declining a request:

✅ Accepting a Request

Response	Register
Sure! / Of course!	informal
No problem at all.	neutral
Certainly. I'll do it right away.	formal
I'd be happy to help.	polite / warm
Sure, leave it to me.	confident, informal

❌ Declining a Request

Response	Register
Sorry, I can't right now.	informal
I'm afraid I won't be able to.	polite
Unfortunately, that's not possible for me today.	formal
I wish I could, but I have another commitment.	polite / apologetic

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Volunteering to Do Something for Someone

olunteering to Do Something for Someone

An offer is when you volunteer to do something to help someone else.

Common structures:

Structure	Example	Translation
Shall I...?	*Shall I carry that for you?*	Quer que eu carregue isso?
I'll...	*I'll get the door.*	Eu abro a porta.
Would you like me to...?	*Would you like me to explain again?*	Quer que eu explique de novo?
Can I...?	*Can I help you with that?*	Posso te ajudar com isso?
Let me...	*Let me check that for you.*	Deixa eu verificar isso pra você.
Do you want me to...?	*Do you want me to call a taxi?*	Quer que eu chame um táxi?

Accepting or Politely Refusing Help

Accepting an offer:

Yes, please! That would be great.

warm, common

That's very kind of you. Thank you.

polite / formal

Please do! I'd appreciate it.

enthusiastic

Thanks, that would really help.

casual / friendly

Requesting to Do Something Yourself

Requesting to Do Something Yourself

Permission is when you ask if *you* are allowed to do something.

Structure	Formality	Example
Can I...?	informal	*Can I use your phone?*
Could I...?	neutral / polite	*Could I leave a bit early today?*
May I...?	formal	*May I speak with the manager, please?*
Is it OK if I...?	neutral / casual	*Is it OK if I bring a friend?*
Do you mind if I...?	polite / considerate	*Do you mind if I open the window?*
Would it be all right if I...?	formal / careful	*Would it be all right if I worked from home tomorrow?*

Granting or Refusing Permission

Granting or Refusing Permission

Granting permission:

Refusing permission:

Refusing permission:

- ✓ *Sure, go ahead.* (casual)
- ✓ *Yes, of course!* (friendly)
- ✓ *Absolutely. No problem at all.* (enthusiastic)
- ✓ *Yes, you're welcome to.* (polite)

	Response	Register
✗	*Sorry, I'd rather you didn't.*	polite but firm
✗	*I'm afraid that's not possible.*	formal
✗	*Actually, I'd prefer if you didn't.*	soft refusal
✗	*Unfortunately, that's not allowed here.*	rule-based

	Response	Register
✓	*Sure, go ahead.*	casual
✓	*Yes, of course!*	friendly
✗	*Absolutely. No problem at all.*	enthusiastic
✗	*Yes, you're welcome to.*	polite
✗	*Feel free.*	informal / open

Choosing the Right Level of Politeness

The same idea can be expressed in very different ways depending on the situation.

Scenario: You want to borrow someone's pen.

Register	Request
Very informal	*Hey, lend me your pen.*
Neutral	*Can I borrow your pen?*
Polite	*Could I borrow your pen for a second?*
Very polite	*Would you mind if I borrowed your pen?*

Scenario: You want a colleague to review a document.

Register	Request
Informal	*Can you check this for me?*
Polite	*Could you take a look at this?*
Formal	*I was wondering if you could review this document at your earliest convenience.*